

Codex Portable

Professional filmmakers require high-quality video shooting equipment, and more importantly something to store their gigantic files on when out in the field. The Codex Portable is a compact field recorder. It supports recording of video formats all the way up to 4096 x 2048—that's like a little more than two times current HD resolution standards. 8-channel audio streams can be recorded. To store all this data, it has removable 400 or 800 GB hard drives! You can also plug in a cheap USB Flash drive.



Unlike its bigger brother the Codex Recorder, the Codex Portable weighs 4 kg instead of 45. The touchscreen allows you to use the interface, which can also be wirelessly controlled—through a laptop, for example. This whopper should be out towards the end of the year. Serious filmmakers might be the only prospective buyers, and they will be a very happy pack when it does arrive. No price has been stated so far, but our sixth sense (we've still got it!) tells us it isn't going to be cheap.

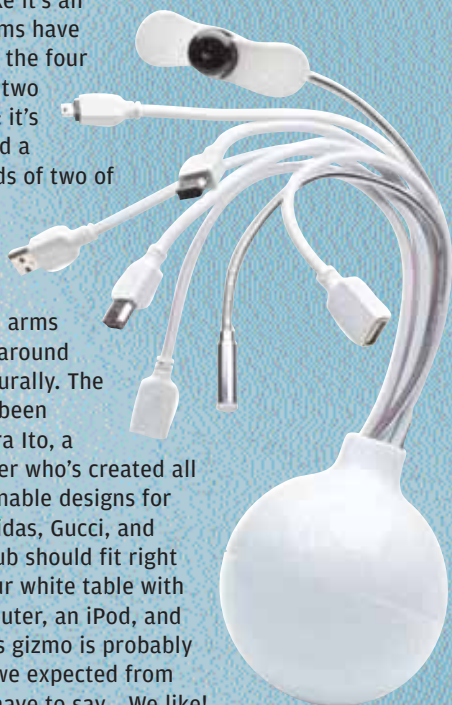


Droolmaal

The good stuff.
Stuff to lust after.
Stuff for the well-moneyed.

Lacie Hub

You've probably heard of Lacie products—they're mostly huge disks or highly-expensive monitors. Now this hub looks like a bulb, and it's got tentacles popping out like it's an octopus. Its arms have more than just the four USB ports and two FireWire ports: it's got a fan at and a light at the ends of two of its arms respectively. It also has an extendable USB cable. The arms can be moved around and bent... naturally. The Lacie Hub has been designed by Ora Ito, a famous designer who's created all sorts of fashionable designs for brands like Adidas, Gucci, and Swatch. The Hub should fit right in place on your white table with an Apple computer, an iPod, and an iPhone. This gizmo is probably the last thing we expected from Lacie, but we have to say... We like!



The Drop

A drop is literally what these things look like. They are speakers—and really good ones at that—from a little-known company called Scandyna. These 2.3 kg "Drops" are hardly your typical Desktop speakers: they're two feet high including the spiked legs. They can be set up for stereo or 5.1 surround. Equally stylish accessories are available; these can allow you to hang them off the ceiling or on walls. These speakers come in six gaudy colours—white, black, silver, blue, yellow, and red. (Yellow... ugh!) Very stylish, a Drop set costs £549 (Rs 45,000). That's the kind of price you pay for in-your-face design—the kind we love the most! (Except for the yellow).

